THE ECONOMIC AND SOCIAL COUNCIL

Composition

Chapter X, Article 61 specifies the guidelines for composition of the Economic and Social Council (ECOSOC). It states that the Council shall consist of 54 members of the United Nations elected by the General Assembly. Subject to the provisions of paragraph 3, 18 members of the Council shall be elected each year for a term of three years. A retiring member shall be eligible for immediate re-election. The ECOSOC is composed of 18 members. Later the number increased to 27 and at present it stands at 54. Each member of the Economic and Social Council shall have one representative.

According to Article 68, ECOSOC shall set up commissions in economic and social fields and for the promotion of human rights, and such other commissions as may be required for the performance of its functions. Article 69 also confers upon the ECOSOC the power to invite any member of the United Nations to participate, without vote, in its deliberations on any matter of particular concern to that member. Article 70 states that the Economic and Social Council may make arrangements for representatives of the specialized agencies to participate, without vote, in its deliberations and in those of the commissions established by it, and for its representatives to participate in the deliberations of the specialized agencies.

Voting

Article 67 stipulates that each member of the Economic and Social Council shall have one vote. Decisions of the Council shall be made by a majority of the members present and voting.

Article 72 states that the Economic and Social Council shall adopt its own rules of procedure, including the method of selecting its President. The Council shall meet as required in accordance with its rules, which shall include provision for the convening of meetings on the request of a majority of its members.

Functions and Powers

Article 62 states that the Economic and Social Council may:

1. Make or initiate studies and reports with respect to international